INTELLIGENCE BRIEF / N° 007 · HOT · TOP TIER

JFrog

DevSecOps / Software Supply Chain Security · Sunnyvale, CA · NASDAQ: FROG

The CMO who ran marketing at Udemy during its multi-series McLaren partnership now runs marketing at JFrog - a profitable, cash-generative public company - and the software-supply-chain-security slot on the F1 grid is still completely empty.

86 OPPORTUNITY / 100	TIMING WINDOW	SERIES	RECOMMENDED TEAM	ACTION HORIZON
	HOT	F1	McLaren	4-6 WKS

THE CASE

On 5 January 2026 JFrog appointed Genefa Murphy as Chief Marketing Officer for what it explicitly framed as its 'next growth phase' in AI-driven software supply chain management. Murphy is the decisive signal in this brief: as Chief Marketing & Content Officer at Udemy she led marketing through its multi-series McLaren Racing partnership (Formula 1, IndyCar, NEOM McLaren Formula E and Extreme E). She is therefore not a cold prospect who must be educated on the value of motorsport - she has been inside exactly this kind of programme - and she now controls the brand budget of a company with $531.8M revenue (+24% YoY), $243.3M cloud revenue (+45%) and $142.3M of free cash flow. The strategic gap is just as compelling as the relationship: while Confluent (data streaming) sits on the Williams livery, no software-supply-chain-security brand exists anywhere on the F1 grid. JFrog's category - the integrity and security of the code that ships software - is the single largest piece of uncontested enterprise whitespace in the paddock, and Murphy's own positioning language maps onto F1 almost word-for-word.

WHY NOW

Three clocks are running simultaneously. First, Murphy is roughly five months into a mandate her own company has branded a growth-phase reset - the precise window in which a new CMO defines the multi-year brand-investment agenda and shapes the next fiscal year's budget, before priorities harden. Second, because she has already delivered an F1/FE programme, the usual internal objection - 'does motorsport actually work for a B2B audience?' - is pre-answered by her personal track record, collapsing the normal 12-18 month education cycle to near zero. Third, the category whitespace is a depreciating asset: the moment a DevSecOps rival (Sonatype, Snyk or GitLab) plants a flag, JFrog's first-mover narrative is gone and the conversation becomes a defensive one. Moving in the next 4-6 weeks captures all three.

PROOF POINTS — EVERY FIGURE VERIFIED TO A PRIMARY SOURCE (SEE P.2)

Genefa Murphy CMO (decision-maker), effective 5 Jan 2026; ex-Udemy CMO during its McLaren partnership	**$531.8M** FY2025 revenue (+24% YoY)	**$142.3M** FY2025 free cash flow (~27% of revenue)
$243.3M FY2025 cloud revenue (+45% YoY)	**119%** Net dollar retention (trailing four quarters)	**Udemy-McLaren** Murphy's precedent: Udemy's multi-series McLaren Racing partnership

GRID FIT — CATEGORY-WHITESPACE CHECK ACROSS THE F1 GRID (1440 TEAM-FIT ENGINE)

McLaren ◆ RECOMMENDED	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Red Bull Racing	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Williams	OPEN	no rival in this category lane
Aston Martin	OPEN	no rival in this category lane

BOTTOM LINE

The CMO who ran marketing at Udemy during its multi-series McLaren partnership now owns the brand budget at JFrog ($531.8M revenue, +24%, FCF-positive) - and the software-supply-chain-security slot on the F1 grid is still empty. A warm, proven motorsport buyer pointed at a clean category.

EXEC MIGRATION · CATEGORY WHITESPACE · NEW LEADERSHIP · FUNDING EVENT · DISCOVERY: SEEDED

WHY MCLAREN

McLaren is the warm, high-probability path. Murphy already knows the McLaren commercial organisation intimately from negotiating and activating the Udemy partnership, so an introduction is a re-engagement rather than a cold pitch, and McLaren's technology-forward, precision-engineering brand identity is the closest cultural mirror on the grid to JFrog's 'secure software, shipped fast' promise. If McLaren's relevant inventory is constrained, Aston Martin is the strong fallback: it carries premium enterprise gravitas, its hospitality audience skews to exactly the CISO and CTO buyers JFrog sells to, and its technology-partner roster leaves the DevSecOps slot open. Either team lets JFrog tell a 'from first commit to chequered flag' supply-chain-integrity story in front of the right room.

VALUE TO MCLAREN — MODE A (TECH IN THE CAR / CHAMPIONSHIP)

MODE A - a genuine two-way technical partnership, not branding alone. A modern F1 team operates a sprawling internal software estate: aerodynamic and strategy simulation, real-time race-systems code, telemetry pipelines and hundreds of engineers shipping builds every week. That is, by definition, a software supply chain - and securing and managing it is exactly what JFrog's platform does (artifact management, binary lifecycle, security scanning across the dev pipeline). A deal can therefore be structured around a real integration into the team's engineering workflow, giving McLaren an authentic 'official software supply chain partner' story it can stand behind technically, plus a credible R&D narrative, plus enterprise hospitality where JFrog's own buyers already gather on race weekends. The team gains tooling and a reference customer; JFrog gains a live proof point and a stage.

DEAL ARCHITECTURE

Recommended entry: Official Software Supply Chain Partner tier on McLaren (Aston Martin as fallback). MINIMUM THREE YEARS at an estimated $3-5M/yr, calibrated to JFrog's $531.8M revenue base. Scope: car and driver-suit branding in the software-supply-chain-security category, garage and B2B hospitality access, digital and content inventory aimed at an enterprise-IT audience, a working technical integration into the team's dev pipeline, and - critically - a category-exclusivity clause that blocks any DevSecOps rival from the team for the life of the contract.

PRIMARY DECISION-MAKER

Genefa Murphy, PhD

CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER, JFROG (APPOINTED 5 JAN 2026) - VERIFIED VIA JFROG PRESS ROOM

The single most important contact in this brief. As Chief Marketing & Content Officer at Udemy she led marketing through its multi-series McLaren Racing partnership (F1, IndyCar, NEOM McLaren Formula E, Extreme E). Previously CMO of Five9, SVP & CMO of Micro Focus, and Global VP Corporate Marketing at HPE. She knows the McLaren commercial organisation and now owns JFrog's brand budget - approach her directly. Co-decision-maker: founder-CEO Shlomi Ben Haim for marquee spend.

OPENING ANGLE

> *"Genefa, you proved at Udemy that an F1 grid is a B2B pipeline channel, not a billboard. The software-supply-chain-security slot is still empty - JFrog can own the one category McLaren's other tech partners can't touch. Can we hold 25 minutes this week before a rival moves?"*

SCORE COMPOSITION

TIMING	CAPACITY	BRAND FIT	URGENCY	OPS FIT
18 / 20	**18** / 20	**19** / 20	**15** / 20	**16** / 20
CMO Genefa Murphy appointed Jan 5 2026 for a declared 'next growth phase'; FY2027 brand-budget planning is forming now, and a new CMO's first marquee investments are typically locked within the first two quarters.	FY2025 revenue $531.8M (+24%), cloud $243.3M (+45%), $142.3M FCF, NDR 119%, 74 customers above $1M ARR. A $3-5M/yr deal is roughly 0.1% of revenue - immaterial to the balance sheet.	No software-supply-chain-security brand is anywhere on the F1 grid (Confluent = data streaming on Williams). JFrog can OWN the category outright, and Murphy's public thesis - 'trust, control and discipline at velocity' - is almost a motorsport tagline already.	Direct rivals Sonatype and Snyk are circling the same whitespace; whoever signs first locks category exclusivity for three years and forces the others onto rival teams.	MODE A: an F1 team ships thousands of software builds a season across simulation, strategy and car systems - that is a literal software supply chain, so JFrog earns a genuine in-garage technical-partner role, not a sticker.

RISKS & COUNTERS

BUDGET CYCLE LAG A discretionary brand-sponsorship line may not be formally approved until the FY2027 cycle. **Counter:** Frame it as a founder-level category land-grab rather than a marketing line item, and offer a short-form LOI to hold category exclusivity now while the budget formalises.

FOUNDER ALIGNMENT Founder-CEO Shlomi Ben Haim is hands-on; a marquee spend needs his explicit buy-in. **Counter:** Position trust and security - JFrog's core message - as a CEO-level brand story, and bring Ben Haim into the room alongside Murphy early.

B2B SKEPTICISM Investors may question motorsport spend at a company at a profitability inflection point. **Counter:** Murphy's Udemy-McLaren results are the proof case; lead with measured B2B pipeline and account-based outcomes, not impressions or reach.

SOURCES

- https://investors.jfrog.com/news/news-details/2026/JFrog-Appoints-Genefa-Murphy-as-Chief-Marketing-Officer-to-Accelerate-Its-Next-Growth-Phase/default.aspx
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